

UPSC Civil Services Preliminary Examination - General Studies Paper I

DETAILED SOLUTIONS / ANSWER KEY | Time: 2 Hours | Maximum Marks: 200

Quick Key

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Detailed solutions

Q1. Answer: A | Polity

Registrar architecture remedial Which institutional statement is correct?

A. State Registrars administer State-law societies, while the Central Registrar administers the MSCS Act - CORRECT: Correct. The two registrar systems follow Entries 32 and 44; banking regulation may overlay but does not replace incorporation authority.

B. The Ministry of Cooperation is the Registrar for all State societies - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The proposition 'The Ministry of Cooperation is the Registrar for all State societies' changes the controlling category, condition or legal source. The two registrar systems follow Entries 32 and 44; banking regulation may overlay but does not replace incorporation authority.

C. The Central Registrar regulates all PACS - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The proposition 'The Central Registrar regulates all PACS' changes the controlling category, condition or legal source. The two registrar systems follow Entries 32 and 44; banking regulation may overlay but does not replace incorporation authority.

D. RBI incorporates every non-banking cooperative - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The proposition 'RBI incorporates every non-banking cooperative' changes the controlling category, condition or legal source. The two registrar systems follow Entries 32 and 44; banking regulation may overlay but does not replace incorporation authority.

Method / explanation: Correct. The two registrar systems follow Entries 32 and 44; banking regulation may overlay but does not replace incorporation authority.

Trap: Separate Ministry policy, registrar administration and RBI prudential functions.

Q2. Answer: B | Polity

Ministry-size controls Consider the following: 1. Union ministry: maximum 15% of Lok Sabha strength. 2. State ministry: maximum 15% of Legislative Assembly strength. 3. State ministry: constitutional minimum of 12. 4. These caps were introduced by the 91st Amendment. Which is correct?

A. 1 and 4 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect. It excludes the State ministry cap and minimum, both expressly contained in Article 164(1A).

B. 1, 2, 3 and 4 - CORRECT: Correct. The 91st Amendment inserted the Union and State 15% caps, with a State minimum of twelve.

C. 1, 2 and 4 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect. It omits the constitutional minimum of twelve ministers for a State Council.

D. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The Union cap and the common amendment source are also correct, so this partial combination is incomplete.

Method / explanation: Correct. The 91st Amendment inserted the Union and State 15% caps, with a State minimum of twelve.

Trap: The 15% ceiling applies at both levels, but only the State provision carries a minimum of twelve.

Q3. Answer: C | Polity

Which statement correctly distinguishes an effective majority from the Article 368 majority?

A. They are identical because vacancies are ignored in both. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Vacancies affect effective strength but do not reduce Article 368's total-membership limb.

B. Article 368 uses only two-thirds of effective strength. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Article 368 neither substitutes effective strength nor uses it as the sole denominator.

C. An effective majority uses the House's then-existing strength after vacancies; Article 368 separately requires a majority of total membership plus two-thirds present and voting. - CORRECT: Correct: The distinction prevents the removal-majority concept used elsewhere from being imported into constitutional amendment arithmetic.

D. Effective majority is the State-ratification rule under Article 368. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: State ratification is by resolution with an ordinary present-and-voting majority, not an effective majority.

Method / explanation: The distinction prevents the removal-majority concept used elsewhere from being imported into constitutional amendment arithmetic.

Trap: "Total membership" in Article 368 means full sanctioned strength, not "all the then members".

Q4. Answer: D | Polity

Which statement about Articles 371 to 371J is correct?

A. They create a single identical package of powers for every State. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The clauses differ substantially in subject, institution and territorial application.

B. They grant separate national citizenship to their beneficiary populations. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. India retains single citizenship; special governance arrangements do not create separate nationality.

C. They operate only during a National Emergency. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. These are continuing constitutional provisions rather than emergency powers.

D. They contain differentiated State-specific arrangements responding to distinct historical and regional needs. - CORRECT: Correct. The family exemplifies asymmetrical accommodation within a common constitutional order.

Method / explanation: Correct. The family exemplifies asymmetrical accommodation within a common constitutional order.

Trap: Never compress the Article 371 family into one uniform privilege.

Q5. Answer: A | Polity

Which statement correctly captures the relationship among Fundamental Rights, DPSP and Fundamental Duties?

A. They differ in legal status but jointly connect liberty, welfare and civic responsibility - CORRECT: Correct. Part III rights are enforceable, Part IV directs governance and Part IV-A articulates citizens' duties; constitutional harmony links their purposes.

B. All three are directly enforceable by writ - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Article 37 expressly makes DPSP non-justiciable, and Duties do not themselves create a writ remedy.

C. DPSP automatically override every Fundamental Right - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Minerva Mills rejects destruction of the Parts III-IV balance in either direction.

D. Duties apply only to governments and never to citizens - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Article 51A addresses Fundamental Duties of citizens.

Method / explanation: Correct. Part III rights are enforceable, Part IV directs governance and Part IV-A articulates citizens' duties; constitutional harmony links their purposes.

Trap: The examiner tests both difference and relationship: neither flatten all three into rights nor isolate them as unrelated lists.

Q6. Answer: B | Polity

Which statement correctly describes creation or abolition of a State Legislative Council?

A. Parliament and the State Assembly both act by an ordinary present-and-voting majority. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Parliament's eventual law is ordinary, but the initiating Assembly resolution needs a majority of total membership plus two-thirds present and voting.

B. The State Assembly first passes the Article 169 resolution by its prescribed special majority; Parliament then enacts an ordinary law outside Article 368. - CORRECT: Correct: Article 169 deliberately combines a special initiating resolution in the State Assembly

with a parliamentary law not deemed an Article 368 amendment.

C. The Governor creates or abolishes the Council after Parliament approves a resolution. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The Governor cannot create or abolish a Legislative Council by executive action.

D. The change always requires an Article 368 amendment ratified by half the States. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Legislative Council creation or abolition follows Article 169, not the federal-ratification proviso.

Method / explanation: Article 169 deliberately combines a special initiating resolution in the State Assembly with a parliamentary law not deemed an Article 368 amendment.

Trap: "Simple-majority constitutional change" describes Parliament's law here, not every prior procedural step.

Q7. Answer: C | Polity

Constitutional status Which statement is constitutionally correct?

A. Hindi is the national language and English is its subordinate associate language. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The Constitution does not use a Hindi-national/English-associate hierarchy. The controlling rule is: Article 343(1) uses the functional expression official language of the Union; no constitutional provision declares a national language.

B. All Eighth-Schedule languages are official languages of the Union. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Scheduled recognition does not confer Union-official status on all 22 languages. The controlling rule is: Article 343(1) uses the functional expression official language of the Union; no constitutional provision declares a national language.

C. Hindi in Devanagari script is the official language of the Union, but the Constitution declares no national language. - CORRECT: Correct. Article 343(1) uses the functional expression official language of the Union; no constitutional provision declares a national language.

D. English is the sole official language named in Article 343. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Article 343 names Hindi, not English, as the Union's official language. The controlling rule is: Article 343(1) uses the functional expression official language of the Union; no constitutional provision declares a national language.

Method / explanation: Correct. Article 343(1) uses the functional expression official language of the Union; no constitutional provision declares a national language.

Trap: Do not convert official-language status into national-language status.

Q8. Answer: D | Polity

Which case-description pair is incorrectly stated?

A. John Vallamattom - discriminatory succession restriction and an Article 44 observation - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "John Vallamattom - discriminatory succession restriction and an Article 44 observation" fails against the controlling rule. Shayara Bano concerned instant triple talaq. No case listed here issued a judicial command enacting or compelling a UCC.

B. Sarla Mudgal - conversion cannot be used to evade an existing marriage - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "Sarla Mudgal - conversion cannot be used to evade an existing marriage" fails against the controlling rule. Shayara Bano concerned instant triple talaq. No case listed here issued a judicial command enacting or compelling a UCC.

C. Shah Bano - secular maintenance law and an Article 44 observation - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "Shah Bano - secular maintenance law and an Article 44 observation" fails against the controlling rule. Shayara Bano concerned instant triple talaq. No case listed here issued a judicial command enacting or compelling a UCC.

D. Shayara Bano - Supreme Court ordered Parliament to enact a UCC within a fixed period - CORRECT: Correct: Shayara Bano concerned instant triple talaq. No case listed here issued a judicial command enacting or compelling a UCC. This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

Method / explanation: Shayara Bano concerned instant triple talaq. No case listed here issued a judicial command enacting or compelling a UCC. This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

Trap: Judicial observations supporting reform are not equivalent to a mandamus directing Parliament to enact a UCC.

Q9. Answer: A | Polity

Advisory jurisdiction Which statement about Article 143 is correct?

A. The President refers; an Article 143(1) opinion is advisory and the Court may decline to answer. - CORRECT: Correct: clause (1) uses a discretionary reporting structure for public-importance questions.

B. A private party may demand an advisory opinion. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the reference power belongs to the President.

C. Every opinion binds future benches exactly like Article 141 precedent. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: an advisory opinion is not an ordinary binding decree.

D. The Court may grant deemed assent to legislation through every reference. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the 2025 assent opinion rejected automatic deemed assent under Article 142.

Method / explanation: clause (1) uses a discretionary reporting structure for public-importance questions.

Trap: Authoritative constitutional advice remains distinct from binding adjudication.

Q10. Answer: B | Polity

Pre-2011 position Which statement correctly describes the position before the 97th Amendment?

A. No cooperative could be incorporated before Article 43B - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The proposition 'No cooperative could be incorporated before Article 43B' changes the controlling category, condition or legal source. The 1904 and 1912 laws and later State/MSCS statutes pre-dated constitutionalisation; the 97th Amendment added constitutional rights, policy and governance provisions rather than creating the form.

B. Cooperatives already existed as statutory bodies under Union or State legislation within the federal competence split - CORRECT: Correct. The 1904 and 1912 laws and later State/MSCS statutes pre-dated constitutionalisation; the 97th Amendment added constitutional rights, policy and governance provisions rather than creating the form.

C. Part IXB was the sole source of all cooperative legal personality - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The proposition 'Part IXB was the sole source of all cooperative legal personality' changes the controlling category, condition or legal source. The 1904 and 1912 laws and later State/MSCS statutes pre-dated constitutionalisation; the 97th Amendment added constitutional rights, policy and governance provisions rather than creating the form.

D. Only Parliament could legislate for every cooperative - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The proposition 'Only Parliament could legislate for every cooperative' changes the controlling category, condition or legal source. The 1904 and 1912 laws and later State/MSCS statutes pre-dated constitutionalisation; the 97th Amendment added constitutional rights, policy and governance provisions rather than creating the form.

Method / explanation: Correct. The 1904 and 1912 laws and later State/MSCS statutes pre-dated constitutionalisation; the 97th Amendment added constitutional rights, policy and governance provisions rather than creating the form.

Trap: Constitutional recognition in 2012 did not erase the older statutory foundation.

Q11. Answer: C | Polity

Financial Bill-II Which statement correctly describes an Article 117(3) Financial Bill?

A. It is a Money Bill. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: it contains expenditure implications without being confined to Article 110.

B. It can originate only in Lok Sabha. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the Lok Sabha-only rule belongs to clause (1).

C. It may originate in either House, but presidential recommendation is required before consideration. - CORRECT: Correct: recommendation timing is before consideration.

D. Rajya Sabha may only recommend changes. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: both Houses otherwise have ordinary-Bill powers.

Method / explanation: recommendation timing is before consideration.

Trap: Do not apply Financial Bill-I restrictions to Financial Bill-II.

Q12. Answer: D | Polity

Article 311 coverage Which statement about Article 311 is correct?

A. It protects every employee of a government-controlled company. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Article 12 status of a corporation does not automatically convert its staff into Union or State civil-post holders.

B. It applies only to permanent gazetted officers. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Temporary or probationary personnel may receive protection when status and punitive action are established.

C. It bars all transfers, suspensions and prosecutions. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Article 311 regulates dismissal, removal and reduction in rank; other actions require their own legal analysis.

D. It protects listed civil-service members and civil-post holders against specified punitive consequences. - CORRECT: Correct. Coverage depends on protected civil status and the specified major consequences.

Method / explanation: Correct. Coverage depends on protected civil status and the specified major consequences.

Trap: Article 311 is a procedural shield against three penalties, not a universal employment code.

Q13. Answer: A | Economy

Which statement about Udyam is most accurate?

A. It provides an official registration identity but not assured finance or productivity. - CORRECT: Correct: Registration reduces identity cost without guaranteeing outcomes. The option states: It provides an official registration identity but not assured finance or productivity.

B. It guarantees collateral-free credit. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: A lender still appraises credit and scheme eligibility. The option states: It guarantees collateral-free credit.

C. It is a product-quality certification. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: ZED and product standards are separate from Udyam. The option states: It is a product-quality certification.

D. It replaces every tax and labour registration. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Other statutory registrations retain their own legal purposes. The option states: It replaces every tax and labour registration.

Method / explanation: Registration reduces identity cost without guaranteeing outcomes. The option states: It provides an official registration identity but not assured finance or productivity.

Trap: Registration is a gateway, not an outcome.

Q14. Answer: B | Economy

Which statement best distinguishes PDS targeting errors?

A. All three mean the same missing stock. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: They require different remedies. The option states: All three mean the same missing stock.

B. Exclusion denies an eligible person; inclusion covers an ineligible record; leakage diverts entitled grain. - CORRECT: Correct: The categories locate different failures. The option states: Exclusion denies an eligible person; inclusion covers an ineligible record; leakage diverts entitled grain.

C. Exclusion is always fiscally beneficial. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Exclusion can create severe welfare loss. The option states: Exclusion is always fiscally beneficial.

D. Leakage occurs only before procurement. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Leakage can occur across delivery. The option states: Leakage occurs only before procurement.

Method / explanation: The categories locate different failures. The option states: Exclusion denies an eligible person; inclusion covers an ineligible record; leakage diverts entitled grain.

Trap: Deletion counts do not prove successful targeting.

Q15. Answer: C | Economy

Which statement about nano urea is evidence-disciplined?

A. One bottle universally replaces one bag in every crop. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Universal equivalence is unsupported. The option states: One bottle universally replaces one bag in every crop.

B. Regulatory approval proves identical yield in every soil. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Approval is not universal efficacy. The option states: Regulatory approval proves identical yield in every soil.

C. Use should follow crop-soil protocols; notification does not prove universal replacement of conventional urea. - CORRECT: Correct: Official and ICAR evidence requires context and rejects blanket replacement. The option states: Use should follow crop-soil protocols; notification does not prove universal replacement of conventional urea.

D. Nano urea supplies phosphorus and potassium automatically. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Nano urea is a nitrogen product. The option states: Nano urea supplies phosphorus and potassium automatically.

Method / explanation: Official and ICAR evidence requires context and rejects blanket replacement. The option states: Use should follow crop-soil protocols; notification does not prove universal replacement of conventional urea.

Trap: Product launch is not agronomic proof.

Q16. Answer: D | Economy

Which statement about APMC law is correct?

A. Parliament enacted one uniform APMC Act for all States. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: No single central APMC Act governs every State. The option states: Parliament enacted one uniform APMC Act for all States.

B. e-NAM automatically repealed every APMC statute. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The platform works within legal arrangements. The option states: e-NAM automatically repealed every APMC statute.

C. CCI directly administers all market yards. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: CCI's antitrust role differs from market administration. The option states: CCI directly administers all market yards.

D. APMCs operate under applicable State marketing laws whose notified produce, areas, licences and fees vary. - CORRECT: Correct: Agricultural-market architecture is State-shaped. The option states: APMCs operate under applicable State marketing laws whose notified produce, areas, licences and fees vary.

Method / explanation: Agricultural-market architecture is State-shaped. The option states: APMCs operate under applicable State marketing laws whose notified produce, areas, licences and fees vary.

Trap: State law, central model and electronic platform are separate.

Q17. Answer: A | Economy

Which statement correctly maps competition oversight?

A. State market authorities shape mandi architecture, while CCI addresses anti-competitive conduct under the Competition Act where applicable. - CORRECT: Correct: Architecture and conduct oversight have different legal homes. The option states: State market authorities shape mandi architecture, while CCI addresses anti-competitive conduct under the Competition Act where applicable.

B. CCI writes every State APMC Act. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: State legislatures and authorities control APMC law. The option states: CCI writes every State APMC Act.

C. APMC committees decide all national cartel cases. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: CCI has the general antitrust mandate. The option states: APMC committees decide all national cartel cases.

D. A large buyer is automatically an unlawful cartel. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Size alone does not prove prohibited conduct. The option states: A large buyer is automatically an unlawful cartel.

Method / explanation: Architecture and conduct oversight have different legal homes. The option states: State market authorities shape mandi architecture, while CCI addresses anti-competitive conduct under the Competition Act where applicable.

Trap: Separate market structure, conduct, evidence and remedy.

Q18. Answer: B | Economy

Which statement about duration is correct? 1. Modified duration approximates percentage price sensitivity to a small yield change. 2. Longer duration generally means greater interest-rate sensitivity. 3. Duration is the probability of issuer default.

A. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 2 follows directly from duration as a sensitivity measure.

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: Duration measures cash-flow timing and local price sensitivity, while convexity refines the estimate.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 3 confuses market-rate sensitivity with credit analysis.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The first two are correct; duration does not estimate default probability.

Method / explanation: Duration measures cash-flow timing and local price sensitivity, while convexity refines the estimate.

Trap: Maturity and duration are related but not identical.

Q19. Answer: C | Economy

Which statement about ICSID and India is correct at the cutoff?

A. India joined automatically through IBRD membership - INCORRECT: Incorrect: ICSID Convention membership is separate. Option text: India joined automatically through IBRD membership

B. ICSID is a sovereign lender to India - INCORRECT: Incorrect: It administers investment dispute settlement. Option text: ICSID is a sovereign lender to India

C. India is neither a signatory nor a Contracting State to the ICSID Convention - CORRECT: Correct: Correct according to the August 2026 official lists. Option text: India is neither a signatory nor a Contracting State to the ICSID Convention

D. Every investor dispute automatically falls under ICSID - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Jurisdiction depends on consent and legal instruments. Option text: Every investor dispute automatically falls under ICSID

Method / explanation: Correct according to the August 2026 official lists. Option text: India is neither a signatory nor a Contracting State to the ICSID Convention

Trap: World Bank Group affiliation does not create ICSID membership. Focus: which statement about icsid and india is correct at the cutoff.

Q20. Answer: D | Economy

Which statement correctly distinguishes supply chain from value chain?

A. They are legally identical terms under every APMC Act. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: No uniform statutory identity exists. The option states: They are legally identical terms under every APMC Act.

B. A value chain excludes logistics and payment. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Value analysis includes rather than excludes operations. The option states: A value chain excludes logistics and payment.

C. A supply chain measures only farmer profit. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Supply chains map more than one income measure. The option states: A supply chain measures only farmer profit.

D. A supply chain maps flows; a value chain also studies value creation, governance and margin distribution. - CORRECT: Correct: The distinction separates operations from value capture. The option states: A supply chain maps flows; a value chain also studies value creation, governance and margin distribution.

Method / explanation: The distinction separates operations from value capture. The option states: A supply chain maps flows; a value chain also studies value creation, governance and margin distribution.

Trap: Efficiency does not guarantee equitable value sharing.

Q21. Answer: A | Economy

Which statement about temperature is correct?

A. Different commodities require different temperature, humidity and handling protocols. - CORRECT: Correct: Product biology determines the protocol. The option states: Different commodities require different temperature, humidity and handling protocols.

B. All perishables use one universal temperature. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: One setting can injure products. The option states: All perishables use one universal temperature.

C. Frozen and chilled storage are identical. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: They involve distinct temperature states. The option states: Frozen and chilled storage are identical.

D. Cooling always improves every commodity. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Some commodities suffer chilling injury. The option states: Cooling always improves every commodity.

Method / explanation: Product biology determines the protocol. The option states: Different commodities require different temperature, humidity and handling protocols.

Trap: Avoid universal temperature claims.

Q22. Answer: B | Economy

Consider the following statements about a listed green debt security: 1. Its proceeds are linked to eligible environmental purposes. 2. Additional allocation and impact disclosures address greenwashing. 3. Its label guarantees repayment. Which statements are correct?

A. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 2 reflects the disclosure and reporting logic of SEBI's green-debt framework.

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: SEBI's 6 February 2023 framework links the label to use, tracking and disclosure of proceeds.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 1 defines the use-of-proceeds character, while statement 3 is false.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: A green label does not improve issuer solvency or create a repayment guarantee.

Method / explanation: SEBI's 6 February 2023 framework links the label to use, tracking and disclosure of proceeds.

Trap: Environmental integrity and credit quality are separate tests.

Q23. Answer: C | Economy

Which statement about land ceilings is correct?

A. They merge scattered parcels without changing ownership. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: This describes consolidation. The option states: They merge scattered parcels without changing ownership.

B. They automatically transfer every leased plot to its tenant. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Tenant ownership depends on separate State provisions. The option states: They automatically transfer every leased plot to its tenant.

C. They set a State-law maximum and identify legally surplus land, subject to units and exemptions. - CORRECT: Correct: Ceilings operate through State definitions of permissible and surplus holdings. The option states: They set a State-law maximum and identify legally surplus land, subject to units and exemptions.

D. They are fixed uniformly by one Union statute. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Land is principally a State legislative field. The option states: They are fixed uniformly by one Union statute.

Method / explanation: Ceilings operate through State definitions of permissible and surplus holdings. The option states: They set a State-law maximum and identify legally surplus land, subject to units and exemptions.

Trap: Declared surplus is not the same as land possessed and distributed.

Q24. Answer: D | Economy

Which statement correctly distinguishes irrigation potential and utilisation?

A. Potential is crop output per litre. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: That is closer to water productivity. The option states: Potential is crop output per litre.

B. Utilisation is identical to gross irrigated area in every dataset. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statistical concepts have distinct denominators. The option states: Utilisation is identical to gross irrigated area in every dataset.

C. Potential proves equitable tail-end delivery. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Distribution still needs evidence. The option states: Potential proves equitable tail-end delivery.

D. Potential is designed capacity; utilisation is the area actually served under the system. - CORRECT: Correct: It separates infrastructure capacity from realised service. The option states: Potential is designed capacity; utilisation is the area actually served under the system.

Method / explanation: It separates infrastructure capacity from realised service. The option states: Potential is designed capacity; utilisation is the area actually served under the system.

Trap: Created capacity is not reliable delivery.

Q25. Answer: A | Ancient History

Consider the following statements: 1. Lothal is useful for bead-working and a basin conventionally identified as a dockyard. 2. Dholavira is useful for reservoirs and a large signboard. 3. Kalibangan is useful for a ploughed-field association. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1, 2 and 3 - CORRECT: Correct: All three are diagnostic site-feature associations. The wording 'conventionally identified' is important for Lothal's basin because function is interpretive.

B. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "1 only" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that all three are diagnostic site-feature associations. The wording 'conventionally identified' is important for Lothal's basin because function is interpretive.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "2 and 3 only" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that all three are diagnostic site-feature associations. The wording 'conventionally identified' is important for Lothal's basin because function is interpretive.

D. 1 and 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "1 and 2 only" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that all three are diagnostic site-feature associations. The wording 'conventionally identified' is important for Lothal's basin because function is interpretive.

Method / explanation: All three are diagnostic site-feature associations. The wording 'conventionally identified' is important for Lothal's basin because function is interpretive.

Trap: Lothal basin, Dholavira signboard and Kalibangan plough marks must stay distinct.

Q26. Answer: B | Ancient History

Which pair best illustrates Buddhist lay patronage in texts?

A. Kharavela and Rudradaman. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: It conflicts with the precise lay support benchmark; the defensible formulation is 'anathapindika and visakha.'. [Q21-B]

B. Anathapindika and Visakha. - CORRECT: Correct: Textual examples should be supplemented by inscriptions from multi-social donors. It matches the tested lay support distinction without erasing chronology or source limits. [Q21-A]

C. Gargi and Maitreyi. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: It conflicts with the precise lay support benchmark; the defensible formulation is 'anathapindika and visakha.'. [Q21-C]

D. Bhadrabahu and Sthulabhadra. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: It conflicts with the precise lay support benchmark; the defensible formulation is 'anathapindika and visakha.'. [Q21-D]

Method / explanation: Textual examples should be supplemented by inscriptions from multi-social donors. It matches the tested lay support distinction without erasing chronology or source limits. [Q21-A]

Trap: For lay support, fix the tradition and chronology before accepting a familiar term; question 21 specifically tests the boundary around Anathapindika and Visakha.

Q27. Answer: C | Ancient History

Which deity-function pair is correctly matched?

A. Varuna-only chariot manufacture, without chronological or source qualification - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Varuna is associated with order and sovereignty. [Q21-B]

B. Ushas-land-tax collection, as a direct material and social identity - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Ushas personifies dawn and renewal. [Q21-C]

C. Agni-sacrificial mediation, as a complete territorial institution - CORRECT: Correct: Agni carries offerings and links humans with deities. [Q21-A]

D. Soma-territorial surveying, throughout every region and textual layer - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Soma is ritual drink, deity and inspiration. [Q21-D]

Method / explanation: Agni carries offerings and links humans with deities. [Q21-A]

Trap: Deity questions test functional associations, not later institutional roles.

Q28. Answer: D | Ancient History

Which one of the following statements about Harappan script is most accurate?

A. It is conclusively Brahmi written only left to right. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "It is conclusively Brahmi written only left to right." is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that the script remains undeciphered. Direction, sign patterns and contexts can be studied, but no secure translation, king-list or continuous historical text is available.

B. It has yielded a continuous historical chronicle. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "It has yielded a continuous historical chronicle." is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that the script remains undeciphered. Direction, sign patterns and contexts can be studied, but no secure translation, king-list or continuous historical text is available.

C. It provides king-lists comparable to Mesopotamia. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "It provides king-lists comparable to Mesopotamia." is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that the script remains undeciphered. Direction, sign patterns and contexts can be studied, but no secure translation, king-list or continuous historical text is available.

D. It is undeciphered; short inscriptions and seal context can be analysed without claiming a translation. - CORRECT: Correct: The script remains undeciphered. Direction, sign patterns and contexts can be studied, but no secure translation, king-list or continuous historical text is available.

Method / explanation: The script remains undeciphered. Direction, sign patterns and contexts can be studied, but no secure translation, king-list or continuous historical text is available.

Trap: Patterned signs can be studied while the script remains undeciphered.

Q29. Answer: A | Medieval History

With reference to Vijayanagara & the Bahmani Kingdom (Deccan), consider the following statements: 1. The Tungabhadra doab was fertile and strategically placed between the two powers. 2. The Krishna-Godavari basin had fertile land and ports controlling regional foreign trade. 3. Talikota immediately ended every remnant of Vijayanagara. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Vijayanagara & the Bahmani Kingdom (Deccan); statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It ended the great age; the kingdom lingered with shrinking territory.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Talikota immediately ended every remnant of Vijayanagara.' and replaces it with 'It ended the great age; the kingdom lingered with shrinking territory.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Talikota immediately ended every remnant of Vijayanagara.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It ended the great age; the kingdom lingered with shrinking territory.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It ended the great age; the kingdom lingered with shrinking territory.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Talikota immediately ended every remnant of Vijayanagara. -> It ended the great age; the kingdom lingered with shrinking territory.

Q30. Answer: B | Medieval History

With reference to The Bhakti & Sufi Movements, consider the following statements: 1. In north India the two major ba-shara orders were Chishti and Suhrawardi. 2. Chishtis such as Muinuddin Chishti, Bakhtiyar Kaki, Baba Farid,

Nizamuddin Auliya and Nasiruddin Chiragh-i-Delhi stressed simplicity, poverty, service, sama and distance from politics. 3. Kabir was a state-backed social reformer. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Kabir was a state-backed social reformer.' and replaces it with 'He focused on individual reform under a true guru and stayed outside royal courts.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about The Bhakti & Sufi Movements; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: He focused on individual reform under a true guru and stayed outside royal courts.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Kabir was a state-backed social reformer.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: He focused on individual reform under a true guru and stayed outside royal courts.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: He focused on individual reform under a true guru and stayed outside royal courts.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Kabir was a state-backed social reformer. -> He focused on individual reform under a true guru and stayed outside royal courts.

Q31. Answer: C | Medieval History

With reference to Art, Architecture & Culture of the Sultanate, consider the following statements: 1. Arches, vaults and domes had long histories in India and West/central Asia. Sultanate workshops expanded particular arcuate geometries, centring and lime-mortar construction without a single-event "introduction." 2. Indigenous craftsmen-stone-cutters, masons and others-were central to Sultanate construction. 3. Arch and dome were invented by the Turks. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Arch and dome were invented by the Turks.' and replaces it with 'They had multiple earlier Indian and transregional histories; Sultanate workshops expanded and recombined particular techniques.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Arch and dome were invented by the Turks.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Art, Architecture & Culture of the Sultanate; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: They had multiple earlier Indian and transregional histories; Sultanate workshops expanded and recombined particular techniques.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: They had multiple earlier Indian and transregional histories; Sultanate workshops expanded and recombined particular techniques.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: They had multiple earlier Indian and transregional histories; Sultanate workshops expanded and recombined particular techniques.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Arch and dome were invented by the Turks. -> They had multiple earlier Indian and transregional histories; Sultanate workshops expanded and recombined particular techniques.

Q32. Answer: D | Medieval History

With reference to Babur & the Central Asian Backdrop, consider the following statements: 1. The Timurid world fragmented after Timur and Shahrukh; Timurid princes repeatedly fought each other, allowing the Uzbeks in Trans-Oxiana and the Safavids in Iran to rise. 2. Babur twice won Samarkand but could not hold it; after Uzbek pressure, he shifted to Kabul (1504). 3. Babur came only because Indian nobles invited him. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Babur came only because Indian nobles invited him.' and replaces it with 'He already had strategic, financial and Timurid motives; invitations only made the moment favourable.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Babur came only because Indian nobles invited him.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: He already had strategic, financial and Timurid motives; invitations only made the moment favourable.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Babur & the Central Asian Backdrop; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: He already had strategic, financial and Timurid motives; invitations only made the moment favourable.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: He already had strategic, financial and Timurid motives; invitations only made the moment favourable.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Babur came only because Indian nobles invited him. -> He already had strategic, financial and Timurid motives; invitations only made the moment favourable.

Q33. Answer: A | Modern History

With reference to India and Her Neighbours (Frontier Policy), consider the following statements: 1. British rulers treated India's neighbours as part of a defensive ring around the empire. 2. Afghanistan became central because of fear of Russian advance in Central Asia, often called the Great Game. 3. Burma was always separate from British India. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about India and Her Neighbours (Frontier Policy); statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It was administered as part of India until 1937.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Burma was always separate from British India.' and replaces it with 'It was administered as part of India until 1937.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Burma was always separate from British India.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It was administered as part of India until 1937.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It was administered as part of India until 1937.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Burma was always separate from British India. -> It was administered as part of India until 1937.

Q34. Answer: B | Modern History

With reference to Foundation of the INC & the Moderate Phase (1885-1905), consider the following statements: 1. Before 1885, educated Indians formed provincial and imperial associations such as the Landholders' Society, British Indian Association, East India Association, Poona Sarvajanik Sabha, Indian Association, Madras Mahajan Sabha and Bombay Presidency Association. 2. These bodies trained early leaders in petitions, public meetings, memorials, press campaigns and constitutional criticism of colonial rule. 3. The INC was created only by the British as a safety valve. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The INC was created only by the British as a safety valve.' and replaces it with 'Bipin Chandra stresses it emerged from Indian national forces; Hume's role did not make it a British creation.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Foundation of the INC & the Moderate Phase (1885-1905); statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Bipin Chandra stresses it emerged from Indian national forces; Hume's role did not make it a British creation.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The INC was created only by the British as a safety valve.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Bipin Chandra stresses it emerged from Indian national forces; Hume's role did not make it a British creation.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Bipin Chandra stresses it emerged from Indian national forces; Hume's role did not make it a British creation.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The INC was created only by the British as a safety valve. -> Bipin Chandra stresses it emerged from Indian national forces; Hume's role did not make it a British creation.

Q35. Answer: C | Modern History

With reference to Militant Nationalism, Swadeshi & the Partition of Bengal, consider the following statements: 1. Militant nationalism grew because many nationalists were dissatisfied with Moderate methods and slow constitutional concessions. 2. Curzon's reactionary measures, including the Calcutta Corporation Act and Universities Act, deepened distrust of official reform. 3. Separate electorates were introduced by the Government of India Act 1919. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Separate electorates were introduced by the Government of India Act 1919.' and replaces it with 'Separate electorates for Muslims were

introduced by Morley-Minto in 1909.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Separate electorates were introduced by the Government of India Act 1919.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Militant Nationalism, Swadeshi & the Partition of Bengal; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Separate electorates for Muslims were introduced by Morley-Minto in 1909.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Separate electorates for Muslims were introduced by Morley-Minto in 1909.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Separate electorates for Muslims were introduced by Morley-Minto in 1909.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Separate electorates were introduced by the Government of India Act 1919. -> Separate electorates for Muslims were introduced by Morley-Minto in 1909.

Q36. Answer: D | Modern History

With reference to Revolutionary Nationalism (Phase I, 1907-1917), consider the following statements: 1. After the Swadeshi movement declined under repression, some young nationalists turned to individual heroism, secret societies and armed action. 2. They believed that dramatic attacks on officials could inspire courage, avenge repression and awaken the nation. 3. Revolutionary nationalism was the same as Gandhian mass satyagraha. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Revolutionary nationalism was the same as Gandhian mass satyagraha.' and replaces it with 'It relied on secret action and heroic violence, not open mass non-violence.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Revolutionary nationalism was the same as Gandhian mass satyagraha.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It relied on secret action and heroic violence, not open mass non-violence.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Revolutionary Nationalism (Phase I, 1907-1917); statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It relied on secret action and heroic violence, not open mass non-violence.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It relied on secret action and heroic violence, not open mass non-violence.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Revolutionary nationalism was the same as Gandhian mass satyagraha. -> It relied on secret action and heroic violence, not open mass non-violence.

Q37. Answer: A | Modern History

With reference to Growth of Communalism & the Muslim League, consider the following statements: 1. Bipan Chandra treats communalism as a modern ideology that converts religious identity into claims about shared secular and political interests; this is a source interpretation, not a synonym for religion. 2. Communalism is not the same as religion, religious reform or personal religiosity. 3. Separate electorates began with the Government of India Act 1919. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Growth of Communalism & the Muslim League; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: They began for Muslims with Morley-Minto in 1909.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Separate electorates began with the Government of India Act 1919.' and replaces it with 'They began for Muslims with Morley-Minto in 1909.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Separate electorates began with the Government of India Act 1919.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: They began for Muslims with Morley-Minto in 1909.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: They began for Muslims with Morley-Minto in 1909.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Separate electorates began with the Government of India Act 1919. -> They began for Muslims with Morley-Minto in 1909.

Q38. Answer: B | Modern History

With reference to First World War, Home Rule League & the Lucknow Pact, consider the following statements: 1. India supported Britain in World War I with men, money and materials; Indian leaders initially expected that loyalty would be rewarded with constitutional reforms. 2. Wartime conditions produced discontent: rising prices, heavier taxation, war loans, shortages and recruitment pressure made British rule appear more exploitative. 3. Separate electorates began with the Lucknow Pact. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Separate electorates began with the Lucknow Pact.' and replaces it with 'They were introduced by Morley-Minto reforms, 1909; Congress accepted them in the Pact.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about First World War, Home Rule League & the Lucknow Pact; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: They were introduced by Morley-Minto reforms, 1909; Congress accepted them in the Pact.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Separate electorates began with the Lucknow Pact.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: They were introduced by Morley-Minto reforms, 1909; Congress accepted them in the Pact.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: They were introduced by Morley-Minto reforms, 1909; Congress accepted them in the Pact.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Separate electorates began with the Lucknow Pact. -> They were introduced by Morley-Minto reforms, 1909; Congress accepted them in the Pact.

Q39. Answer: C | Art and Culture

Which statement is NOT supported by the repaired source base?

A. Ajanta's cave count should not be the analytical point because unfinished or late-counted caves complicate simple totals. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the source base repeatedly warns that Elephanta's precise attribution remains debated. The option tested was 'Ajanta's cave count should not be the analytical point because unfinished or late-counted caves complicate simple totals.'

B. Amaravati's lower Krishna location is a tested prelims discriminator. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the source base repeatedly warns that Elephanta's precise attribution remains debated. The other three are positive controls from the repaired package. The option tested was 'Amaravati's lower Krishna location is a tested prelims discriminator.'

C. Elephanta's exact dynastic patronage is fully settled and should be stated without caution. - CORRECT: Correct: the source base repeatedly warns that Elephanta's precise attribution remains debated. The option tested was 'Elephanta's exact dynastic patronage is fully settled and should be stated without caution.'

D. Hathigumpha is a major narrative source that still requires criticism. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the source base repeatedly warns that Elephanta's precise attribution remains debated. The option tested was 'Hathigumpha is a major narrative source that still requires criticism.'

Method / explanation: the source base repeatedly warns that Elephanta's precise attribution remains debated. The option tested was 'Elephanta's exact dynastic patronage is fully settled and should be stated without caution.'

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q40. Answer: D | Art and Culture

Which site-feature pair is correctly matched?

A. Lothal - securely identified royal palace - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Lothal's famous basin is debated, Dholavira is well known for reservoirs, and Kalibangan represents regional variation rather than perfect duplication. The option tested was 'Lothal - securely identified royal palace'.

B. Dholavira - absence of reservoirs - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Lothal's famous basin is debated, Dholavira is well known for reservoirs, and Kalibangan represents regional variation rather than perfect duplication. The option tested was 'Dholavira - absence of reservoirs'.

C. Kalibangan - exact copy of Mohenjo-daro in all details - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Mohenjo-daro is the classic site for the Great Bath and strong drainage evidence. The option tested was 'Kalibangan - exact copy of Mohenjo-daro in all details'.

D. Mohenjo-daro - Great Bath and integrated drainage emphasis - CORRECT: Correct: Mohenjo-daro is the classic site for the Great Bath and strong drainage evidence. The option tested was 'Mohenjo-daro - Great Bath and integrated drainage emphasis'.

Method / explanation: Mohenjo-daro is the classic site for the Great Bath and strong drainage evidence. The option tested was 'Mohenjo-daro - Great Bath and integrated drainage emphasis'.

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q41. Answer: A | Art and Culture

Which statement about Nataraja chronology is safest?

A. Pre-Chola antecedents are known, including the Ravana Phadi cave at Aihole, while Chola bronzes gave the form its canonical portable expression. - CORRECT: Correct: The source supports this exact identification. The option tested was 'Pre-Chola antecedents are known, including the Ravana Phadi cave at Aihole, while Chola bronzes gave the form its canonical portable expression.'.

B. The Cholas invented the Nataraja image from nothing. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'The Cholas invented the Nataraja image from nothing.'.

C. The earliest known Nataraja in the source bank is a Mughal-period bronze. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'The earliest known Nataraja in the source bank is a Mughal-period bronze.'.

D. Nataraja belongs to Buddhist iconography rather than Shaiva imagery. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'Nataraja belongs to Buddhist iconography rather than Shaiva imagery.'.

Method / explanation: The source supports this exact identification. The option tested was 'Pre-Chola antecedents are known, including the Ravana Phadi cave at Aihole, while Chola bronzes gave the form its canonical portable expression.'.

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q42. Answer: B | Art and Culture

Which statement best explains guru-shishya parampara?

A. It is merely a modern bureaucratic exam system. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'It is merely a modern bureaucratic exam system.'.

B. It is the embodied transmission mechanism through which technique, correction and sampradaya survive across generations. - CORRECT: Correct: it captures transmission, technique and style memory together. The option tested was 'It is the embodied transmission mechanism through which technique, correction and sampradaya survive across generations.'.

C. It means every form has only one correct national style. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: it captures transmission, technique and style memory together. The option tested was 'It means every form has only one correct national style.'.

D. It eliminates the need for rehearsal. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'It eliminates the need for rehearsal.'.

Method / explanation: it captures transmission, technique and style memory together. The option tested was 'It is the embodied transmission mechanism through which technique, correction and sampradaya survive across generations.'.

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q43. Answer: C | Art and Culture

Which statement best explains the rise of regional miniature schools after Mughal contraction?

A. Regional schools arose because all earlier manuscript traditions disappeared. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: it links political change with workshop mobility. The option tested was 'Regional schools arose because all earlier manuscript traditions disappeared.'.

B. Regional schools rejected all earlier Persianate or Indian influences. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'Regional schools rejected all earlier Persianate or Indian influences.'.

C. Reduced central patronage and the movement of artists helped regional courts adapt shared miniature resources in distinctive ways. - CORRECT: Correct: The source supports this exact identification. The option tested was 'Reduced central patronage and the movement of artists helped regional courts adapt shared miniature resources in distinctive ways.'.

D. Only one regional school survived, so comparison is unnecessary. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'Only one regional school survived, so comparison is unnecessary.'.

Method / explanation: The source supports this exact identification. The option tested was 'Reduced central patronage and the movement of artists helped regional courts adapt shared miniature resources in distinctive ways.'.

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q44. Answer: D | Art and Culture

Which statement about the 1927 Parliament building is safest?

A. Its design was conclusively proved by official records to be copied from Mitaoli. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: It belongs to the Lutyens-Baker imperial Delhi phase,

and the Mitaoli influence claim should be treated as debated rather than documentary certainty. The option tested was 'Its design was conclusively proved by official records to be copied from Mitaoli.'

B. It was designed by Bimal Patel for the Central Vista project. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: It belongs to the Lutyens-Baker imperial Delhi phase, and the Mitaoli influence claim should be treated as debated rather than documentary certainty. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim. The option tested was 'It was designed by Bimal Patel for the Central Vista project.'

C. It was demolished after the new Parliament was opened. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: It belongs to the Lutyens-Baker imperial Delhi phase, and the Mitaoli influence claim should be treated as debated rather than documentary certainty. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim. The option tested was 'It was demolished after the new Parliament was opened.'

D. It belongs to the Lutyens-Baker imperial Delhi phase, and the Mitaoli influence claim should be treated as debated rather than documentary certainty. - CORRECT: Correct: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: It belongs to the Lutyens-Baker imperial Delhi phase, and the Mitaoli influence claim should be treated as debated rather than documentary certainty. The option tested was 'It belongs to the Lutyens-Baker imperial Delhi phase, and the Mitaoli influence claim should be treated as debated rather than documentary certainty.'

Method / explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: It belongs to the Lutyens-Baker imperial Delhi phase, and the Mitaoli influence claim should be treated as debated rather than documentary certainty. The option tested was 'It belongs to the Lutyens-Baker imperial Delhi phase, and the Mitaoli influence claim should be treated as debated rather than documentary certainty.'

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q45. Answer: A | Geography

With reference to The Arctic or Polar Climate, consider the following statements: 1. Polar climate lies mainly north of the Arctic Circle; ice-cap (Greenland) vs tundra (lowlands). 2. Warmest month $< \sim 10^{\circ}\text{C}$; ≤ 4 months above freezing; low snow precipitation $\rightarrow$ cold desert. 3. "Ice-cap" and "tundra" are the same. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about The Arctic or Polar Climate; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: ice-cap = permanent ice (Greenland); tundra = ice-free summer lowlands with vegetation.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects "'Ice-cap" and "tundra" are the same.' and replaces it with 'ice-cap = permanent ice (Greenland); tundra = ice-free summer lowlands with vegetation.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: "Ice-cap" and "tundra" are the same.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: ice-cap = permanent ice (Greenland); tundra = ice-free summer lowlands with vegetation.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: ice-cap = permanent ice (Greenland); tundra = ice-free summer lowlands with vegetation.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: "Ice-cap" and "tundra" are the same. $\rightarrow$ ice-cap = permanent ice (Greenland); tundra = ice-free summer lowlands with vegetation.

Q46. Answer: B | Geography

With reference to World Population and Demographic Transition, consider the following statements: 1. In demographic transition, death rates usually fall before birth rates. 2. Population pyramid = age-sex structure at a glance. 3. Stage 2 means both birth and death rates fall together. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Stage 2 means both birth and death rates fall together.' and replaces it with 'In standard DTM, death rate usually falls first while birth rate stays high for some time.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about World Population and Demographic Transition; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: In standard DTM, death rate usually falls first while birth rate stays high for some time.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Stage 2 means both birth and death rates fall together.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: In standard DTM, death rate usually falls first while birth rate stays high for some time.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: In standard DTM, death rate usually falls first while birth rate stays high for some time.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Stage 2 means both birth and death rates fall together. -> In standard DTM, death rate usually falls first while birth rate stays high for some time.

Q47. Answer: C | Geography

With reference to Migration: Theories and Spatial Patterns, consider the following statements: 1. Migration is a component of population change, along with fertility and mortality. 2. Push and pull can operate together; the same factor may push one group and attract another. 3. Refugees and voluntary emigrants are the same. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Refugees and voluntary emigrants are the same.' and replaces it with 'Forced and voluntary movements differ legally and analytically.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Refugees and voluntary emigrants are the same.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Migration: Theories and Spatial Patterns; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Forced and voluntary movements differ legally and analytically.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Forced and voluntary movements differ legally and analytically.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Forced and voluntary movements differ legally and analytically.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Refugees and voluntary emigrants are the same. -> Forced and voluntary movements differ legally and analytically.

Q48. Answer: D | Geography

With reference to Human Settlements and Urbanisation, consider the following statements: 1. Settlement pattern and settlement function are not the same thing. 2. Dispersed settlements often reflect terrain, farm size or resource spread. 3. A metropolis and a conurbation are identical. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'A metropolis and a conurbation are identical.' and replaces it with 'A metropolis may be one city; a conurbation is merged built-up spread.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: A metropolis and a conurbation are identical.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: A metropolis may be one city; a conurbation is merged built-up spread.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Human Settlements and Urbanisation; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: A metropolis may be one city; a conurbation is merged built-up spread.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: A metropolis may be one city; a conurbation is merged built-up spread.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A metropolis and a conurbation are identical. -> A metropolis may be one city; a conurbation is merged built-up spread.

Q49. Answer: A | Geography

With reference to Regional Development and Five-Year Plans, consider the following statements: 1. Regional development is about territorial balance, not just national GDP growth. 2. Growth can spread outward or create backwash and dependency. 3. Balanced regional development means every place must grow at the same rate. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Regional Development and Five-Year Plans; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: The real aim is reducing harmful disparities, not uniformity.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Balanced regional development means every place must grow at the same rate.' and replaces it with 'The real aim is reducing harmful disparities, not uniformity.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Balanced regional development means every place must grow at the same rate.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: The real aim is reducing harmful disparities, not uniformity.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: The real aim is reducing harmful disparities, not uniformity.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Balanced regional development means every place must grow at the same rate. -> The real aim is reducing harmful disparities, not uniformity.

Q50. Answer: B | Geography

With reference to Primary Economic Activities: Agriculture, consider the following statements: 1. Shifting cultivation uses temporary plots and fallow rotation; it is not the same as plantation farming. 2. Plantation agriculture is large-scale, monocultural and export-oriented. 3. All large farms are commercial grain farms. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'All large farms are commercial grain farms.' and replaces it with 'Ranching, plantation and corporate horticulture are different systems.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Primary Economic Activities: Agriculture; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Ranching, plantation and corporate horticulture are different systems.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: All large farms are commercial grain farms.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Ranching, plantation and corporate horticulture are different systems.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Ranching, plantation and corporate horticulture are different systems.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: All large farms are commercial grain farms. -> Ranching, plantation and corporate horticulture are different systems.

Q51. Answer: C | Geography

With reference to Mineral & Energy Resources: Classification, World Belts & Strategic Significance, consider the following statements: 1. Ferrous minerals are centred on iron-steel systems; non-ferrous include copper and bauxite. 2. Coal and petroleum occur mainly in sedimentary formations. 3. All minerals are renewable because they can be recycled. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'All minerals are renewable because they can be recycled.' and replaces it with 'Recycling reduces pressure but does not make mineral stocks renewable.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: All minerals are renewable because they can be recycled.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Mineral & Energy Resources: Classification, World Belts & Strategic Significance; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Recycling reduces pressure but does not make mineral stocks renewable.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Recycling reduces pressure but does not make mineral stocks renewable.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Recycling reduces pressure but does not make mineral stocks renewable.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: All minerals are renewable because they can be recycled. -> Recycling reduces pressure but does not make mineral stocks renewable.

Q52. Answer: D | Geography

With reference to Industries & Industrial Regions, consider the following statements: 1. Weber's model is a least-cost industrial-location theory. 2. Raw-material orientation is strongest where inputs are bulky or lose weight during processing. 3. An industrial region is just a resource region. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'An industrial region is just a resource region.' and replaces it with 'It is a wider manufacturing cluster with transport and urban linkages.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: An industrial region is just a resource region.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It is a wider manufacturing cluster with transport and urban linkages.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Industries & Industrial Regions; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It is a wider manufacturing cluster with transport and urban linkages.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It is a wider manufacturing cluster with transport and urban linkages.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: An industrial region is just a resource region. -> It is a wider manufacturing cluster with transport and urban linkages.

Q53. Answer: A | Geography

With reference to Transport, Trade & Space Networks, consider the following statements: 1. Roads are best for flexible last-mile movement. 2. Rail is well suited to bulk inland freight. 3. Trade geography is only about exports and imports. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Transport, Trade & Space Networks; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It is also about routes, nodes, costs, chokepoints and hinterlands.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Trade geography is only about exports and imports.' and replaces it with 'It is also about routes, nodes, costs, chokepoints and hinterlands.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Trade geography is only about exports and imports.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It is also about routes, nodes, costs, chokepoints and hinterlands.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It is also about routes, nodes, costs, chokepoints and hinterlands.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Trade geography is only about exports and imports. -> It is also about routes, nodes, costs, chokepoints and hinterlands.

Q54. Answer: B | Geography

With reference to World Regional Geography: Continents, Regions & Country Groupings, consider the following statements: 1. Asia is the largest continent in both area and population in the source framework. 2. Antarctica is a polar desert despite its ice cover. 3. North America and Latin America are identical categories. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'North America and Latin America are identical categories.' and replaces it with 'Latin America includes Mexico onward, not the whole continent.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about World Regional Geography: Continents, Regions & Country Groupings; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Latin America includes Mexico onward, not the whole continent.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: North America and Latin America are identical categories.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Latin America includes Mexico onward, not the whole continent.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Latin America includes Mexico onward, not the whole continent.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: North America and Latin America are identical categories. -> Latin America includes Mexico onward, not the whole continent.

Q55. Answer: C | Geography

With reference to Political Geography: Boundaries, Frontiers & Geopolitical Theories, consider the following statements: 1. River boundaries can become disputed when the channel shifts. 2. Watershed boundaries are common in mountain

regions. 3. Geopolitical theory is separate from geography. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Geopolitical theory is separate from geography.' and replaces it with 'classical theory is built precisely on geography of land, sea and access.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Geopolitical theory is separate from geography.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Political Geography: Boundaries, Frontiers & Geopolitical Theories; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: classical theory is built precisely on geography of land, sea and access.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: classical theory is built precisely on geography of land, sea and access.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: classical theory is built precisely on geography of land, sea and access.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Geopolitical theory is separate from geography. -> classical theory is built precisely on geography of land, sea and access.

Q56. Answer: D | Geography

With reference to Contemporary Geographical Issues: Conceptual Lenses for India, consider the following statements: 1. A dispute is geographical when terrain or basin structure materially shapes it. 2. A hazard becomes a governance issue when land use amplifies natural exposure. 3. Urban flooding is only due to heavy rain. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Urban flooding is only due to heavy rain.' and replaces it with 'drainage design, encroachment and land cover are equally important.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Urban flooding is only due to heavy rain.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: drainage design, encroachment and land cover are equally important.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Contemporary Geographical Issues: Conceptual Lenses for India; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: drainage design, encroachment and land cover are equally important.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: drainage design, encroachment and land cover are equally important.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Urban flooding is only due to heavy rain. -> drainage design, encroachment and land cover are equally important.

Q57. Answer: A | Environment

With reference to Renewable Energy and Green Hydrogen, consider the following statements: 1. Green hydrogen is produced via electrolysis powered by renewable electricity, distinguishing it from grey hydrogen (fossil-fuel-based, no capture) and blue hydrogen (fossil-fuel-based, with carbon capture). 2. The National Green Hydrogen Mission, approved in January 2023, targets 5 million metric tonnes per annum of green-hydrogen production capacity by 2030. 3. Allocated green-hydrogen capacity means green hydrogen is being produced at that scale. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Renewable Energy and Green Hydrogen; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: 862,000 tonnes per year allocated to 18 companies is contracted intent; commissioned production is a separate figure.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Allocated green-hydrogen capacity means green hydrogen is being produced at that scale.' and replaces it with '862,000 tonnes per year allocated to 18 companies is contracted intent; commissioned production is a separate figure.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Allocated green-hydrogen capacity means green hydrogen is being produced at that scale.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: 862,000 tonnes per year allocated to 18 companies is contracted intent; commissioned production is a separate figure.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: 862,000 tonnes per year allocated to 18 companies is contracted intent; commissioned production is a separate figure.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Allocated green-hydrogen capacity means green hydrogen is being produced at that scale. -> 862,000 tonnes per year allocated to 18 companies is contracted intent; commissioned production is a separate figure.

Q58. Answer: B | Environment

With reference to Disaster Management Framework and Sendai, consider the following statements: 1. The Disaster Management Act, 2005 established a three-tier structure: NDMA (chaired by the Prime Minister), SDMA (chaired by the Chief Minister) and DDMA (chaired by the District Magistrate/Collector). 2. The Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction 2015-2030 was adopted in 2015 at the UN's Third World Conference on Disaster Risk Reduction in Sendai, Japan, succeeding the Hyogo Framework for Action. 3. The Sendai Framework's "global targets" and its "priorities for action" are the same list. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The Sendai Framework's "global targets" and its "priorities for action" are the same list.' and replaces it with 'There are four priorities for action and seven global targets (A-G) - a distinction UPSC has tested directly.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Disaster Management Framework and Sendai; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: There are four priorities for action and seven global targets (A-G) - a distinction UPSC has tested directly.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The Sendai Framework's "global targets" and its "priorities for action" are the same list.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: There are four priorities for action and seven global targets (A-G) - a distinction UPSC has tested directly.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: There are four priorities for action and seven global targets (A-G) - a distinction UPSC has tested directly.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The Sendai Framework's "global targets" and its "priorities for action" are the same list. -> There are four priorities for action and seven global targets (A-G) - a distinction UPSC has tested directly.

Q59. Answer: C | Environment

With reference to Environmental Institutions MoEFCC CPCB NBA WII, consider the following statements: 1. MoEFCC is India's nodal ministry for environmental policy and international convention implementation. 2. CPCB is the apex pollution-regulation body under the Water Act, 1974 and Air Act, 1981. 3. NTCA and WCCB are the same body with different names. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'NTCA and WCCB are the same body with different names.' and replaces it with 'NTCA is specifically for tiger conservation/Project Tiger; WCCB is a broader wildlife-crime-coordination body covering all species.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: NTCA and WCCB are the same body with different names.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Environmental Institutions MoEFCC CPCB NBA WII; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: NTCA is specifically for tiger conservation/Project Tiger; WCCB is a broader wildlife-crime-coordination body covering all species.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: NTCA is specifically for tiger conservation/Project Tiger; WCCB is a broader wildlife-crime-coordination body covering all species.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: NTCA is specifically for tiger conservation/Project Tiger; WCCB is a broader wildlife-crime-coordination body covering all species.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: NTCA and WCCB are the same body with different names. -> NTCA is specifically for tiger conservation/Project Tiger; WCCB is a broader wildlife-crime-coordination body covering all species.

Q60. Answer: D | Environment

With reference to Ecosystem Structure and Function, consider the following statements: 1. It is a zone of variable width and a zone of ecological tension/competition, not a line on a map. 2. Decomposers are heterotrophic and act on dead organic matter; detritivores (e.g., earthworms) physically fragment it before microbial decomposition. 3. An ecotone is simply a boundary line. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'It is a zone of variable width and a zone of ecological tension/competition, not a line on a map.'

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'It is a zone of variable width and a zone of ecological tension/competition, not a line on a map.'

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'An ecotone is simply a boundary line.' with 'It is a zone of variable width and a zone of ecological tension/competition, not a line on a map.'. It separately supports statement 2: Decomposers are heterotrophic and act on dead organic matter; detritivores (e.g., earthworms) physically fragment it before microbial decomposition.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: An ecotone is simply a boundary line. -> It is a zone of variable width and a zone of ecological tension/competition, not a line on a map.

Q61. Answer: A | Environment

With reference to Biogeochemical Cycles and Ecological Pyramids, consider the following statements: 1. It is a sedimentary cycle with negligible atmospheric presence. 2. Phosphorus has no significant atmospheric phase, unlike carbon and nitrogen. 3. Phosphorus cycle has a major atmospheric phase like carbon. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'It is a sedimentary cycle with negligible atmospheric presence.'

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'It is a sedimentary cycle with negligible atmospheric presence.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Phosphorus cycle has a major atmospheric phase like carbon.' with 'It is a sedimentary cycle with negligible atmospheric presence.'. It separately supports statement 2: Phosphorus has no significant atmospheric phase, unlike carbon and nitrogen.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Phosphorus cycle has a major atmospheric phase like carbon. -> It is a sedimentary cycle with negligible atmospheric presence.

Q62. Answer: B | Environment

With reference to Ecological Succession and Biomes, consider the following statements: 1. The sere is the whole sequence; a seral stage is one community within it. 2. A climax community is relatively stable but not permanently fixed - a major disturbance can reset succession. 3. "Sere" and "seral stage" mean the same thing. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'The sere is the whole sequence; a seral stage is one community within it.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'The sere is the whole sequence; a seral stage is one community within it.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception "'Sere" and "seral stage" mean the same thing.' with 'The sere is the whole sequence; a seral stage is one community within it.'. It separately supports statement 2: A climax community is relatively stable but not permanently fixed - a major disturbance can reset succession.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: "Sere" and "seral stage" mean the same thing. -> The sere is the whole sequence; a seral stage is one community within it.

Q63. Answer: C | Environment

With reference to Biodiversity Levels and Hotspots, consider the following statements: 1. Alpha diversity is within-habitat diversity (richness and evenness); richness is only the species count. 2. India hosts four global biodiversity hotspots: Himalaya, Indo-Burma, Western Ghats-Sri Lanka, and Sundaland (represented in India by the Nicobar Islands). 3. Alpha diversity and species richness are the same thing. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Alpha diversity is within-habitat diversity (richness and evenness); richness is only the species count.'

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Alpha diversity is within-habitat diversity (richness and evenness); richness is only the species count.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Alpha diversity and species richness are the same thing.' with 'Alpha diversity is within-habitat diversity (richness and evenness); richness is only the species count.'. It separately supports statement 2: India hosts four global biodiversity hotspots: Himalaya, Indo-Burma, Western Ghats-Sri Lanka, and Sundaland (represented in India by the Nicobar Islands).

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Alpha diversity and species richness are the same thing. -> Alpha diversity is within-habitat diversity (richness and evenness); richness is only the species count.

Q64. Answer: D | Environment

With reference to IUCN Red List and Endemism, consider the following statements: 1. It means there is insufficient information to assess risk, which can itself warrant precautionary conservation attention. 2. Data Deficient does not mean a species is safe - it means insufficient data exists to assess its risk. 3. Data Deficient means a species is not at risk. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'It means there is insufficient information to assess risk, which can itself warrant precautionary conservation attention.'

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'It means there is insufficient information to assess risk, which can itself warrant precautionary conservation attention.'

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Data Deficient means a species is not at risk.' with 'It means there is insufficient information to assess risk, which can itself warrant precautionary conservation attention.'. It separately supports statement 2: Data Deficient does not mean a species is safe - it means insufficient data exists to assess its risk.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Data Deficient means a species is not at risk. -> It means there is insufficient information to assess risk, which can itself warrant precautionary conservation attention.

Q65. Answer: A | Environment

With reference to Protected Area Network India, consider the following statements: 1. ESZ extent is site-specific and fixed by the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. 2. Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves were introduced by a later (2002) amendment to extend protection to buffer and community/private lands. 3. Every protected area has a uniform 10 km Eco-Sensitive Zone. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'ESZ extent is site-specific and fixed by the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width.'

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'ESZ extent is site-specific and fixed by the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Every protected area has a uniform 10 km Eco-Sensitive Zone.' with 'ESZ extent is site-specific and fixed by the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width.'. It separately supports statement 2: Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves were introduced by a later (2002) amendment to extend protection to buffer and community/private lands.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Every protected area has a uniform 10 km Eco-Sensitive Zone. -> ESZ extent is site-specific and fixed by the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width.

Q66. Answer: B | Environment

With reference to Biosphere Reserves and Ramsar Sites, consider the following statements: 1. The Montreux Record sits within the Ramsar List; it flags adverse ecological change and triggers advisory assistance, not delisting. 2. The Ramsar Convention (1971) is specifically about wetlands, named after the city of Ramsar, Iran, where it was signed. 3. Being on the Montreux Record means a site has lost Ramsar status. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'The Montreux Record sits within the Ramsar List; it flags adverse ecological change and triggers advisory assistance, not delisting.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'The Montreux Record sits within the Ramsar List; it flags adverse ecological change and triggers advisory assistance, not delisting.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Being on the Montreux Record means a site has lost Ramsar status.' with 'The Montreux Record sits within the Ramsar List; it flags adverse ecological change and triggers advisory assistance, not delisting.'. It separately supports statement 2: The Ramsar Convention (1971) is specifically about wetlands, named after the city of Ramsar, Iran, where it was signed.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Being on the Montreux Record means a site has lost Ramsar status. -> The Montreux Record sits within the Ramsar List; it flags adverse ecological change and triggers advisory assistance, not delisting.

Q67. Answer: C | Environment

With reference to Wildlife Protection Act and Schedules, consider the following statements: 1. CITES obligations are given domestic legal effect through instruments like the Wildlife Protection Act's Schedule IV structure. 2. The Wildlife (Protection) Amendment Act, 2022 restructured the earlier six-schedule system into four schedules. 3. CITES itself is enforced directly in India without domestic legislation. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'CITES obligations are given domestic legal effect through instruments like the Wildlife Protection Act's Schedule IV structure.'

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'CITES obligations are given domestic legal effect through instruments like the Wildlife Protection Act's Schedule IV structure.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'CITES itself is enforced directly in India without domestic legislation.' with 'CITES obligations are given domestic legal effect through instruments like the Wildlife Protection Act's Schedule IV structure.'. It separately supports statement 2: The Wildlife (Protection) Amendment Act, 2022 restructured the earlier six-schedule system into four schedules.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: CITES itself is enforced directly in India without domestic legislation. -> CITES obligations are given domestic legal effect through instruments like the Wildlife Protection Act's Schedule IV structure.

Q68. Answer: D | Environment

With reference to CITES and Wildlife Trade, consider the following statements: 1. Appendix III listing is a unilateral act by a single Party; only Appendices I and II require a two-thirds CoP majority. 2. CITES came into force in 1975; decisions on Appendix listings are made at its periodic Conference of the Parties (CoP). 3. Adding a species to Appendix III requires a CoP vote. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Appendix III listing is a unilateral act by a single Party; only Appendices I and II require a two-thirds CoP majority.'

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Appendix III listing is a unilateral act by a single Party; only Appendices I and II require a two-thirds CoP majority.'

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Adding a species to Appendix III requires a CoP vote.' with 'Appendix III listing is a unilateral act by a single Party; only Appendices I and II require a two-thirds CoP majority.'. It separately supports statement 2: CITES came into force in 1975; decisions on Appendix listings are made at its periodic Conference of the Parties (CoP).

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Adding a species to Appendix III requires a CoP vote. -> Appendix III listing is a unilateral act by a single Party; only Appendices I and II require a two-thirds CoP majority.

Q69. Answer: A | Science and Technology

With reference to General Science: Physics Fundamentals, consider the following statements: 1. Newton's third law explains action-reaction pairs; the two forces act on different bodies. 2. Work is zero if there is no displacement in the direction of force, even if force is applied. 3. Escape velocity depends on the mass of the object being launched. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about General Science: Physics Fundamentals; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It does not; it depends on the mass and radius of the body being escaped.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Escape velocity depends on the mass of the object being launched.' and replaces it with 'It does not; it depends on the mass and radius of the body being escaped.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Escape velocity depends on the mass of the object being launched.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It does not; it depends on the mass and radius of the body being escaped.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It does not; it depends on the mass and radius of the body being escaped.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Escape velocity depends on the mass of the object being launched. -> It does not; it depends on the mass and radius of the body being escaped.

Q70. Answer: B | Science and Technology

With reference to General Science: Chemistry Fundamentals, consider the following statements: 1. Atomic number, not atomic mass, is the basis of the modern periodic table. 2. Alkali metals are highly reactive metals; halogens are highly reactive non-metals. 3. A catalyst increases the yield of a reaction at equilibrium. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'A catalyst increases the yield of a reaction at equilibrium.' and replaces it with 'It speeds the approach to equilibrium; it does not shift the equilibrium position.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about General Science: Chemistry Fundamentals; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It speeds the approach to equilibrium; it does not shift the equilibrium position.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: A catalyst increases the yield of a reaction at equilibrium.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It speeds the approach to equilibrium; it does not shift the equilibrium position.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It speeds the approach to equilibrium; it does not shift the equilibrium position.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A catalyst increases the yield of a reaction at equilibrium. -> It speeds the approach to equilibrium; it does not shift the equilibrium position.

Q71. Answer: C | Science and Technology

With reference to General Science: Biology and Physiology, consider the following statements: 1. Prokaryotic cells lack a true membrane-bound nucleus; eukaryotic cells possess one. 2. Mitochondria are linked with cellular respiration; chloroplasts with photosynthesis. 3. Virus and bacteria can be treated identically in biology questions. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Virus and bacteria can be treated identically in biology questions.' and replaces it with 'One is acellular and host-dependent; the other is cellular and independently living.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Virus and bacteria can be treated identically in biology questions.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about General Science: Biology and Physiology; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: One is acellular and host-dependent; the other is cellular and independently living.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: One is acellular and host-dependent; the other is cellular and independently living.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: One is acellular and host-dependent; the other is cellular and independently living.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Virus and bacteria can be treated identically in biology questions. -> One is acellular and host-dependent; the other is cellular and independently living.

Q72. Answer: D | Science and Technology

With reference to S&T Institutions: DST, CSIR, ANRF and SERB, consider the following statements: 1. DST was established in May 1971 as a nodal department for science and technology promotion and coordination. 2. CSIR's official page describes it as a network of 37 national laboratories with pan-India presence. 3. ANRF is just another live name for SERB with no structural change. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'ANRF is just another live name for SERB with no structural change.' and replaces it with 'ANRF is the successor statutory framework with a wider strategic remit; the SERB Act is repealed and SERB dissolved.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: ANRF is just another live name for SERB with no structural change.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: ANRF is the successor statutory framework with a wider strategic remit; the SERB Act is repealed and SERB dissolved.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about S&T Institutions: DST, CSIR, ANRF and SERB; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: ANRF is the successor statutory framework with a wider strategic remit; the SERB Act is repealed and SERB dissolved.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: ANRF is the successor statutory framework with a wider strategic remit; the SERB Act is repealed and SERB dissolved.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: ANRF is just another live name for SERB with no structural change. -> ANRF is the successor statutory framework with a wider strategic remit; the SERB Act is repealed and SERB dissolved.

Q73. Answer: A | Science and Technology

With reference to Scientific Discoveries, Nobel Prizes and Scientists, consider the following statements: 1. Born in Cambridge, United Kingdom, in 1942. 2. Affiliated at the time of the award with the University of California, Berkeley, USA. 3. A current-affairs name list is sufficient. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Scientific Discoveries, Nobel Prizes and Scientists; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: The underlying mechanism remains examinable after the name becomes stale.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'A current-affairs name list is sufficient.' and replaces it with 'The underlying mechanism remains examinable after the name becomes stale.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: A current-affairs name list is sufficient.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: The underlying mechanism remains examinable after the name becomes stale.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: The underlying mechanism remains examinable after the name becomes stale.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A current-affairs name list is sufficient. -> The underlying mechanism remains examinable after the name becomes stale.

Q74. Answer: B | Science and Technology

With reference to Space Programme, ISRO, Launch Vehicles and Space Governance, consider the following statements:

1. The policy separates public, regulatory and commercial roles; it does not abolish state leadership. 2. PSLV is described by ISRO as the workhorse launcher with multiple variants and a strong success record. 3. Space Policy 2023 means the government has withdrawn from the space sector. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'The policy separates public, regulatory and commercial roles; it does not abolish state leadership.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'The policy separates public, regulatory and commercial roles; it does not abolish state leadership.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Space Policy 2023 means the government has withdrawn from the space sector.' with 'The policy separates public, regulatory and commercial roles; it does not abolish state leadership.'. It separately supports statement 2: PSLV is described by ISRO as the workhorse launcher with multiple variants and a strong success record.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Space Policy 2023 means the government has withdrawn from the space sector. -> The policy separates public, regulatory and commercial roles; it does not abolish state leadership.

Q75. Answer: C | Science and Technology

With reference to Satellites, NavIC, GAGAN and Applications, consider the following statements: 1. NavIC is regional by design (India plus ~1500 km); this is a deliberate cost-and-coverage choice, not a shortfall. 2. GAGAN is a Satellite Based Augmentation System jointly developed by ISRO and AAI for civil-aviation navigation requirements. 3. NavIC is a global system like GPS/GLONASS/Galileo/BeiDou. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'NavIC is regional by design (India plus ~1500 km); this is a deliberate cost-and-coverage choice, not a shortfall.'

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'NavIC is regional by design (India plus ~1500 km); this is a deliberate cost-and-coverage choice, not a shortfall.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'NavIC is a global system like GPS/GLONASS/Galileo/BeiDou.' with 'NavIC is regional by design (India plus ~1500 km); this is a deliberate cost-and-coverage choice, not a shortfall.'. It separately supports statement 2: GAGAN is a Satellite Based Augmentation System jointly developed by ISRO and AAI for civil-aviation navigation requirements.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: NavIC is a global system like GPS/GLONASS/Galileo/BeiDou. -> NavIC is regional by design (India plus ~1500 km); this is a deliberate cost-and-coverage choice, not a shortfall.

Q76. Answer: D | Science and Technology

With reference to Human Spaceflight, Gaganyaan and Planetary Missions, consider the following statements: 1. It is a solar observatory placed in halo orbit around Sun-Earth L1 for continuous observation. 2. The Gaganyaan orbital module consists of a Crew Module and a Service Module. 3. Aditya-L1 means India has "landed on the Sun.". Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'It is a solar observatory placed in halo orbit around Sun-Earth L1 for continuous observation.'

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'It is a solar observatory placed in halo orbit around Sun-Earth L1 for continuous observation.'

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Aditya-L1 means India has "landed on the Sun."' with 'It is a solar observatory placed in halo orbit around Sun-Earth L1 for continuous observation.'. It separately supports statement 2: The Gaganyaan orbital module consists of a Crew Module and a Service Module.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Aditya-L1 means India has "landed on the Sun.". -> It is a solar observatory placed in halo orbit around Sun-Earth L1 for continuous observation.

Q77. Answer: A | Science and Technology

With reference to Nuclear Power and the Three-Stage Programme, consider the following statements: 1. Liability deals with compensation architecture; safety regulation is handled through regulatory oversight and standards. 2. Stage 2 centres on fast breeder reactors using plutonium to expand fissile-material availability. 3. Civil nuclear liability law is the same thing as reactor-safety regulation. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Liability deals with compensation architecture; safety regulation is handled through regulatory oversight and standards.'

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Liability deals with compensation architecture; safety regulation is handled through regulatory oversight and standards.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception 'Civil nuclear liability law is the same thing as reactor-safety regulation.' with 'Liability deals with compensation architecture; safety regulation is handled through regulatory oversight and standards.'. It separately supports statement 2: Stage 2 centres on fast breeder reactors using plutonium to expand fissile-material availability.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Civil nuclear liability law is the same thing as reactor-safety regulation. -> Liability deals with compensation architecture; safety regulation is handled through regulatory oversight and standards.

Q78. Answer: B | Science and Technology

With reference to Nuclear Fusion and ITER, consider the following statements: 1. Q compares fusion power to injected plasma heating power only; it ignores magnets, cryoplant, pumps and conversion losses. Engineering breakeven is a far higher bar. 2. ITER is an experimental project intended to demonstrate feasibility and bridge the gap toward later power-producing systems; it is not a commercial plant. 3. "Q = 10 means the plant produces ten times the electricity it consumes.". Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 is explicitly rejected by the source; its correction is 'Q compares fusion power to injected plasma heating power only; it ignores magnets, cryoplant, pumps and conversion losses. Engineering breakeven is a far higher bar.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statement 1 is the source's correction and statement 2 is an independent source-grounded fact; statement 3 restates the rejected misconception.

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, whereas statement 3 remains the source's rejected trap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the inclusion of statement 3 makes the all-statements option fail; the valid boundary is 'Q compares fusion power to injected plasma heating power only; it ignores magnets, cryoplant, pumps and conversion losses. Engineering breakeven is a far higher bar.'

Method / explanation: The source explicitly corrects the misconception "'Q = 10 means the plant produces ten times the electricity it consumes.'" with 'Q compares fusion power to injected plasma heating power only; it ignores magnets, cryoplant, pumps and conversion losses. Engineering breakeven is a far higher bar.'. It separately supports statement 2: ITER is an experimental project intended to demonstrate feasibility and bridge the gap toward later power-producing systems; it is not a commercial plant.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: "Q = 10 means the plant produces ten times the electricity it consumes.". -> Q compares fusion power to injected plasma heating power only; it ignores magnets, cryoplant, pumps and conversion losses. Engineering breakeven is a far higher bar.

Q79. Answer: C | Governance and Security

With reference to Regulatory Governance and Independent Regulators, consider the following statements: 1. The Tribunals Reforms Act, 2021 abolished several appellate tribunals/authorities (including under the Cinematograph Act, 1952; Trade Marks Act, 1999; Copyright Act, 1957; and certain Customs Act and Airports Authority of India Act appellate bodies), transferring their functions mainly to High Courts. 2. FSLRC (2013), chaired by Justice B.N. Srikrishna, proposed a Unified Financial Agency to subsume most financial regulators except the RBI - a proposal not implemented in full. 3.

The Tribunals Reforms Act, 2021 abolished all tribunals in India. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The Tribunals Reforms Act, 2021 abolished all tribunals in India.' and replaces it with 'It abolished a specific, named set of appellate tribunals/authorities (not all tribunals), transferring their functions to existing courts, while also prescribing (originally) standardised service conditions for the remaining tribunal system.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The Tribunals Reforms Act, 2021 abolished all tribunals in India.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Regulatory Governance and Independent Regulators; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It abolished a specific, named set of appellate tribunals/authorities (not all tribunals), transferring their functions to existing courts, while also prescribing (originally) standardised service conditions for the remaining tribunal system.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It abolished a specific, named set of appellate tribunals/authorities (not all tribunals), transferring their functions to existing courts, while also prescribing (originally) standardised service conditions for the remaining tribunal system.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It abolished a specific, named set of appellate tribunals/authorities (not all tribunals), transferring their functions to existing courts, while also prescribing (originally) standardised service conditions for the remaining tribunal system.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The Tribunals Reforms Act, 2021 abolished all tribunals in India. -> It abolished a specific, named set of appellate tribunals/authorities (not all tribunals), transferring their functions to existing courts, while also prescribing (originally) standardised service conditions for the remaining tribunal system.

Q80. Answer: D | Governance and Security

With reference to Local Governance and Service Delivery, consider the following statements: 1. The 3Fs of effective devolution are Funds, Functions and Functionaries. 2. District Planning Committees consolidate Panchayat and Municipal development plans into a single district development plan. 3. District Planning Committees function uniformly and effectively across all states. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'District Planning Committees function uniformly and effectively across all states.' and replaces it with 'DPC functioning varies significantly; many states have not fully operationalised DPCs as effective, empowered planning bodies.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: District Planning Committees function uniformly and effectively across all states.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: DPC functioning varies significantly; many states have not fully operationalised DPCs as effective, empowered planning bodies.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Local Governance and Service Delivery; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: DPC functioning varies significantly; many states have not fully operationalised DPCs as effective, empowered planning bodies.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: DPC functioning varies significantly; many states have not fully operationalised DPCs as effective, empowered planning bodies.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: District Planning Committees function uniformly and effectively across all states. -> DPC functioning varies significantly; many states have not fully operationalised DPCs as effective, empowered planning bodies.

Q81. Answer: A | Governance and Security

With reference to Public Finance and Service-Delivery Tools, consider the following statements: 1. JAM stands for Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile - the technical foundation for India's digital financial-inclusion and benefit-transfer architecture. 2. PFMS is administered by the Department of Expenditure, Ministry of Finance. 3. Any specific cumulative DBT savings figure is a fixed, permanently citable number. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Public Finance and Service-Delivery Tools; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Such figures rise continuously as the DBT Mission/PFMS dashboard's reporting period extends; the durable proposition is that DBT reduces leakage from fake, duplicate and ineligible beneficiaries, not any single cumulative rupee total.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Any specific cumulative DBT savings figure is a fixed, permanently citable number.' and replaces it with 'Such figures rise continuously as the DBT Mission/PFMS dashboard's reporting period extends; the durable proposition is that DBT reduces leakage from fake, duplicate

and ineligible beneficiaries, not any single cumulative rupee total.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Any specific cumulative DBT savings figure is a fixed, permanently citable number.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Such figures rise continuously as the DBT Mission/PFMS dashboard's reporting period extends; the durable proposition is that DBT reduces leakage from fake, duplicate and ineligible beneficiaries, not any single cumulative rupee total.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Such figures rise continuously as the DBT Mission/PFMS dashboard's reporting period extends; the durable proposition is that DBT reduces leakage from fake, duplicate and ineligible beneficiaries, not any single cumulative rupee total.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Any specific cumulative DBT savings figure is a fixed, permanently citable number. -> Such figures rise continuously as the DBT Mission/PFMS dashboard's reporting period extends; the durable proposition is that DBT reduces leakage from fake, duplicate and ineligible beneficiaries, not any single cumulative rupee total.

Q82. Answer: B | Governance and Security

With reference to Participatory Governance, consider the following statements: 1. Subsidiarity holds that decisions should be made at the lowest level capable of handling them effectively, closest to those affected and to the relevant information. 2. The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of the Government of India dates to 2014. 3. Holding a Gram Sabha or Ward Committee meeting on schedule is itself proof of genuine participation. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Holding a Gram Sabha or Ward Committee meeting on schedule is itself proof of genuine participation.' and replaces it with 'Frequency of meetings does not guarantee participation quality - meetings can be ceremonial ratifications of pre-decided plans.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Participatory Governance; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Frequency of meetings does not guarantee participation quality - meetings can be ceremonial ratifications of pre-decided plans.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Holding a Gram Sabha or Ward Committee meeting on schedule is itself proof of genuine participation.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Frequency of meetings does not guarantee participation quality - meetings can be ceremonial ratifications of pre-decided plans.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Frequency of meetings does not guarantee participation quality - meetings can be ceremonial ratifications of pre-decided plans.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Holding a Gram Sabha or Ward Committee meeting on schedule is itself proof of genuine participation. -> Frequency of meetings does not guarantee participation quality - meetings can be ceremonial ratifications of pre-decided plans.

Q83. Answer: C | Governance and Security

With reference to Monitoring, Evaluation and Outcomes, consider the following statements: 1. DMEO was formed in 2015 by merging the Programme Evaluation Organisation and the Independent Evaluation Office under NITI Aayog. 2. The Output-Outcome Monitoring Framework is administered by the Ministry of Finance's Budget Division as part of the Union Budget process. 3. The Aspirational Districts Programme ranks districts only on their absolute performance level. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The Aspirational Districts Programme ranks districts only on their absolute performance level.' and replaces it with 'Its delta-ranking system specifically rewards the pace of improvement, incentivising effort regardless of starting position.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The Aspirational Districts Programme ranks districts only on their absolute performance level.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Monitoring, Evaluation and Outcomes; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Its delta-ranking system specifically rewards the pace of improvement, incentivising effort regardless of starting position.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Its delta-ranking system specifically rewards the pace of improvement, incentivising effort regardless of starting position.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Its delta-ranking system specifically rewards the pace of improvement, incentivising effort regardless of starting position.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The Aspirational Districts Programme ranks districts only on their absolute performance level. -> Its delta-ranking system specifically rewards the pace of improvement, incentivising effort regardless of starting position.

Q84. Answer: D | Governance and Security

With reference to Sports Governance, Institutions and Major Tournaments, consider the following statements: 1. Sports federation autonomy does not mean immunity from national law, anti-doping rules, financial accountability or judicial review. 2. Recognition of a federation, selection of athletes and organisation of an event are distinct functions. 3. A wild card means rules do not apply. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'A wild card means rules do not apply.' and replaces it with 'The player bypasses ordinary ranking acceptance, not eligibility, conduct or anti-doping rules.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: A wild card means rules do not apply.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: The player bypasses ordinary ranking acceptance, not eligibility, conduct or anti-doping rules.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Sports Governance, Institutions and Major Tournaments; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: The player bypasses ordinary ranking acceptance, not eligibility, conduct or anti-doping rules.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: The player bypasses ordinary ranking acceptance, not eligibility, conduct or anti-doping rules.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A wild card means rules do not apply. -> The player bypasses ordinary ranking acceptance, not eligibility, conduct or anti-doping rules.

Q85. Answer: A | Governance and Security

With reference to Salient Features and Diversity of Indian Society, consider the following statements: 1. Four major language families in India: Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic, Tibeto-Burman. 2. Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages (constitutional detail; full doctrine is Polity's territory). 3. Every minority or tribal group is automatically marginalised. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Salient Features and Diversity of Indian Society; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Marginality is conditional on historical exclusion and access, not an automatic consequence of being culturally distinct - several diverse communities are economically prosperous.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Every minority or tribal group is automatically marginalised.' and replaces it with 'Marginality is conditional on historical exclusion and access, not an automatic consequence of being culturally distinct - several diverse communities are economically prosperous.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Every minority or tribal group is automatically marginalised.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Marginality is conditional on historical exclusion and access, not an automatic consequence of being culturally distinct - several diverse communities are economically prosperous.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Marginality is conditional on historical exclusion and access, not an automatic consequence of being culturally distinct - several diverse communities are economically prosperous.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Every minority or tribal group is automatically marginalised. -> Marginality is conditional on historical exclusion and access, not an automatic consequence of being culturally distinct - several diverse communities are economically prosperous.

Q86. Answer: B | Governance and Security

With reference to Caste System: Structure and Contemporary Dynamics, consider the following statements: 1. M.N. Srinivas coined both "Sanskritisation" and "dominant caste" based on his fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka. 2. Sanskritisation is upward emulation within the existing hierarchy; Westernisation introduces new values from Western contact - the two can occur together or separately. 3. Dominant caste always means the ritually highest caste. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Dominant caste always means the ritually highest caste.' and replaces it with 'Dominance rests on numbers, land and political power, which can belong to a middle-ranked caste that is locally numerous and land-owning, not necessarily the ritually top-ranked caste.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Caste System: Structure and Contemporary Dynamics; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Dominance rests on numbers, land and political power, which can belong to a middle-ranked caste that is locally numerous and land-owning, not necessarily the ritually top-ranked caste.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Dominant caste always means the ritually highest caste.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Dominance rests on numbers, land and political power, which can belong to a middle-ranked caste that is locally numerous and land-owning, not necessarily the ritually top-ranked caste.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Dominance rests on numbers, land and political power, which can belong to a middle-ranked caste that is locally numerous and land-owning, not necessarily the ritually top-ranked caste.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Dominant caste always means the ritually highest caste. -> Dominance rests on numbers, land and political power, which can belong to a middle-ranked caste that is locally numerous and land-owning, not necessarily the ritually top-ranked caste.

Q87. Answer: C | Governance and Security

With reference to Tribe and Tribal Society, consider the following statements: 1. Verrier Elwin advocated isolation/protection; G.S. Ghurye advocated assimilation ("backward Hindus"); Jawaharlal Nehru's Panchsheel for Tribals advocated integration. 2. MoTA identifies 75 PVTGs in 18 States and the UT of Andaman & Nicobar Islands. Its legacy criteria include pre-agricultural level of technology, low literacy, stagnant/declining population and subsistence economy. 3. Elwin, Ghurye and Nehru held the same view on tribal policy. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Elwin, Ghurye and Nehru held the same view on tribal policy.' and replaces it with 'They represent three distinct positions - isolation, assimilation and integration - and Nehru's Panchsheel was explicitly framed as a middle path rejecting both Elwin's and Ghurye's extremes.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Elwin, Ghurye and Nehru held the same view on tribal policy.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Tribe and Tribal Society; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: They represent three distinct positions - isolation, assimilation and integration - and Nehru's Panchsheel was explicitly framed as a middle path rejecting both Elwin's and Ghurye's extremes.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: They represent three distinct positions - isolation, assimilation and integration - and Nehru's Panchsheel was explicitly framed as a middle path rejecting both Elwin's and Ghurye's extremes.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: They represent three distinct positions - isolation, assimilation and integration - and Nehru's Panchsheel was explicitly framed as a middle path rejecting both Elwin's and Ghurye's extremes.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Elwin, Ghurye and Nehru held the same view on tribal policy. -> They represent three distinct positions - isolation, assimilation and integration - and Nehru's Panchsheel was explicitly framed as a middle path rejecting both Elwin's and Ghurye's extremes.

Q88. Answer: D | Governance and Security

With reference to Family, Marriage and Kinship, consider the following statements: 1. The Khasi of Meghalaya and, traditionally, the Nair of Kerala are the most commonly cited matrilineal kinship systems in India. 2. Gotra exogamy (marrying outside the paternal clan lineage) is observed widely alongside caste endogamy - the two rules are not contradictory. 3. Caste endogamy and gotra exogamy contradict each other. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Caste endogamy and gotra exogamy contradict each other.' and replaces it with 'They operate on different levels - endogamy restricts marriage to within the caste, exogamy restricts it to outside the clan/gotra within that caste - and both rules typically apply together.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Caste endogamy and gotra exogamy contradict each other.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: They operate on different levels - endogamy restricts marriage to within the caste, exogamy restricts it to outside the clan/gotra within that caste - and both rules typically apply together.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Family, Marriage and Kinship; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: They operate on different levels - endogamy restricts marriage to within

the caste, exogamy restricts it to outside the clan/gotra within that caste - and both rules typically apply together.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: They operate on different levels - endogamy restricts marriage to within the caste, exogamy restricts it to outside the clan/gotra within that caste - and both rules typically apply together.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Caste endogamy and gotra exogamy contradict each other. -> They operate on different levels - endogamy restricts marriage to within the caste, exogamy restricts it to outside the clan/gotra within that caste - and both rules typically apply together.

Q89. Answer: A | Governance and Security

With reference to Rural Society and Agrarian Change, consider the following statements: 1. M.N. Srinivas coined "dominant caste" from his Rampura (Karnataka) village fieldwork, the same study that produced "Sanskritisation." 2. Jajmani relationships were often hereditary and involved customary grain/in-kind payments, but local records also show cash and mixed forms; avoid treating "no cash" as a universal definition. 3. Dominant caste always means the ritually highest-ranked caste in a village. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Rural Society and Agrarian Change; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Dominance rests on numbers, land and political power, which can belong to a middle-ranked but locally numerous and land-owning caste.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Dominant caste always means the ritually highest-ranked caste in a village.' and replaces it with 'Dominance rests on numbers, land and political power, which can belong to a middle-ranked but locally numerous and land-owning caste.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Dominant caste always means the ritually highest-ranked caste in a village.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Dominance rests on numbers, land and political power, which can belong to a middle-ranked but locally numerous and land-owning caste.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Dominance rests on numbers, land and political power, which can belong to a middle-ranked but locally numerous and land-owning caste.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Dominant caste always means the ritually highest-ranked caste in a village. -> Dominance rests on numbers, land and political power, which can belong to a middle-ranked but locally numerous and land-owning caste.

Q90. Answer: B | Governance and Security

With reference to Population and Associated Issues, consider the following statements: 1. National Population Policy, 2000 set immediate, medium-term and long-term goals culminating in a stable population aligned with sustainable development. 2. Women's education is a major social determinant associated with fertility transition, alongside marriage age, health services, income, norms and state context. 3. National Population Policy, 2000 set a coercive one-child or two-child national target. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'National Population Policy, 2000 set a coercive one-child or two-child national target.' and replaces it with 'NPP 2000 is a rights-based, tiered-objective policy focused on unmet need, replacement fertility and long-term stabilisation, not a coercive mandate.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Population and Associated Issues; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: NPP 2000 is a rights-based, tiered-objective policy focused on unmet need, replacement fertility and long-term stabilisation, not a coercive mandate.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: National Population Policy, 2000 set a coercive one-child or two-child national target.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: NPP 2000 is a rights-based, tiered-objective policy focused on unmet need, replacement fertility and long-term stabilisation, not a coercive mandate.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: NPP 2000 is a rights-based, tiered-objective policy focused on unmet need, replacement fertility and long-term stabilisation, not a coercive mandate.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: National Population Policy, 2000 set a coercive one-child or two-child national target. -> NPP 2000 is a rights-based, tiered-objective policy focused on unmet need, replacement fertility and long-term stabilisation, not a coercive mandate.

Q91. Answer: C | Current Affairs

A policy analyst uses Union Budget 2026-27 (1 February 2026) to make the following claims: 1. The Annual Financial Statement is constitutionally linked to Article 112. 2. A dated target, allocation, approval or meeting may be treated as an achieved outcome without checking status. 3. The competent institution and legal category must be identified before drawing an inference. Which claims are methodologically sound?

A. 1 and 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: claim 2 is precisely the status error that current-affairs elimination should reject.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: claim 1 is also sound, whereas claim 2 is not.

C. 1 and 3 only - CORRECT: Correct: claims 1 and 3 preserve conceptual and institutional discipline; claim 2 collapses announced or intermediate status into achievement.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be accepted because claim 2 removes the required status check.

Method / explanation: [Fact] The Union Budget 2026-27 followed the Economic Survey on 1 February 2026. [Analysis] The Annual Financial Statement is constitutionally linked to Article 112.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q92. Answer: D | Current Affairs

A policy analyst uses Economic Survey 2025-26 (29 January 2026) to make the following claims: 1. The Survey is a policy and analytical document, not a constitutional money bill. 2. A dated target, allocation, approval or meeting may be treated as an achieved outcome without checking status. 3. The competent institution and legal category must be identified before drawing an inference. Which claims are methodologically sound?

A. 1 and 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: claim 2 is precisely the status error that current-affairs elimination should reject.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: claim 1 is also sound, whereas claim 2 is not.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be accepted because claim 2 removes the required status check.

D. 1 and 3 only - CORRECT: Correct: claims 1 and 3 preserve conceptual and institutional discipline; claim 2 collapses announced or intermediate status into achievement.

Method / explanation: [Fact] The Economic Survey 2025-26 was tabled in Parliament on 29 January 2026. [Analysis] The Survey is a policy and analytical document, not a constitutional money bill.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q93. Answer: A | Current Affairs

A policy analyst uses Economic Survey growth assessment (29 January 2026) to make the following claims: 1. A Survey projection is a dated analytical estimate, not a guaranteed outturn. 2. A dated target, allocation, approval or meeting may be treated as an achieved outcome without checking status. 3. The competent institution and legal category must be identified before drawing an inference. Which claims are methodologically sound?

A. 1 and 3 only - CORRECT: Correct: claims 1 and 3 preserve conceptual and institutional discipline; claim 2 collapses announced or intermediate status into achievement.

B. 1 and 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: claim 2 is precisely the status error that current-affairs elimination should reject.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: claim 1 is also sound, whereas claim 2 is not.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be accepted because claim 2 removes the required status check.

Method / explanation: [Fact] The Economic Survey placed FY 2025-26 real GDP growth at 7.4% FAE and projected FY 2026-27 growth at 6.8-7.2%. [Analysis] A Survey projection is a dated analytical estimate, not a guaranteed outturn.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q94. Answer: B | Current Affairs

A policy analyst uses RBI macro-risk assessment (5 August 2026) to make the following claims: 1. External shocks affect inflation, growth, fiscal costs and the balance of payments through different transmission channels. 2. A dated target, allocation, approval or meeting may be treated as an achieved outcome without checking status. 3. The competent institution and legal category must be identified before drawing an inference. Which claims are methodologically sound?

A. 1 and 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: claim 2 is precisely the status error that current-affairs elimination should reject.

B. 1 and 3 only - CORRECT: Correct: claims 1 and 3 preserve conceptual and institutional discipline; claim 2 collapses announced or intermediate status into achievement.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: claim 1 is also sound, whereas claim 2 is not.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be accepted because claim 2 removes the required status check.

Method / explanation: [Fact] RBI's 5 August 2026 statement flagged volatile oil, sticky global inflation, elevated yields, US-dollar strength and uneven monsoon risk. [Analysis] External shocks affect inflation, growth, fiscal costs and the balance of payments through different transmission channels.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q95. Answer: C | Current Affairs

A policy analyst uses India's 100th Ramsar site milestone (5 June 2026) to make the following claims: 1. Ramsar designation recognises a Wetland of International Importance but does not by itself prove management effectiveness. 2. A dated target, allocation, approval or meeting may be treated as an achieved outcome without checking status. 3. The competent institution and legal category must be identified before drawing an inference. Which claims are methodologically sound?

A. 1 and 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: claim 2 is precisely the status error that current-affairs elimination should reject.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: claim 1 is also sound, whereas claim 2 is not.

C. 1 and 3 only - CORRECT: Correct: claims 1 and 3 preserve conceptual and institutional discipline; claim 2 collapses announced or intermediate status into achievement.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be accepted because claim 2 removes the required status check.

Method / explanation: [Fact] India reached 100 Ramsar sites on 5 June 2026, with Surha Tal in Ballia district recorded as the 100th site. [Analysis] Ramsar designation recognises a Wetland of International Importance but does not by itself prove management effectiveness.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q96. Answer: D | Current Affairs

A policy analyst uses Non-fossil installed-capacity milestone (31 December 2025) to make the following claims: 1. Installed capacity share is not the same as electricity-generation share or energy-consumption share. 2. A dated target, allocation, approval or meeting may be treated as an achieved outcome without checking status. 3. The competent institution and legal category must be identified before drawing an inference. Which claims are methodologically sound?

A. 1 and 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: claim 2 is precisely the status error that current-affairs elimination should reject.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: claim 1 is also sound, whereas claim 2 is not.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be accepted because claim 2 removes the required status check.

D. 1 and 3 only - CORRECT: Correct: claims 1 and 3 preserve conceptual and institutional discipline; claim 2 collapses announced or intermediate status into achievement.

Method / explanation: [Fact] Non-fossil sources accounted for 51.93% of India's installed power capacity at end-December 2025. [Analysis] Installed capacity share is not the same as electricity-generation share or energy-consumption share.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q97. Answer: A | Current Affairs

A policy analyst uses Renewable-capacity addition (31 December 2025) to make the following claims: 1. Capacity added is a flow over a period; installed capacity is a stock at a date. 2. A dated target, allocation, approval or meeting may be treated as an achieved outcome without checking status. 3. The competent institution and legal category must be identified before drawing an inference. Which claims are methodologically sound?

A. 1 and 3 only - CORRECT: Correct: claims 1 and 3 preserve conceptual and institutional discipline; claim 2 collapses announced or intermediate status into achievement.

B. 1 and 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: claim 2 is precisely the status error that current-affairs elimination should reject.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: claim 1 is also sound, whereas claim 2 is not.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be accepted because claim 2 removes the required status check.

Method / explanation: [Fact] India added 38.61 GW of renewable capacity in 2025-26 up to 31 December 2025, according to the Economic Survey evidence card. [Analysis] Capacity added is a flow over a period; installed capacity is a stock at a date.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q98. Answer: B | Current Affairs

A policy analyst uses Kulasekarapattinam SSLV launch complex (21 June 2026) to make the following claims: 1. An approved or under-construction launch facility is not an operational facility. 2. A dated target, allocation, approval or meeting may be treated as an achieved outcome without checking status. 3. The competent institution and legal category must be identified before drawing an inference. Which claims are methodologically sound?

A. 1 and 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: claim 2 is precisely the status error that current-affairs elimination should reject.

B. 1 and 3 only - CORRECT: Correct: claims 1 and 3 preserve conceptual and institutional discipline; claim 2 collapses announced or intermediate status into achievement.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: claim 1 is also sound, whereas claim 2 is not.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be accepted because claim 2 removes the required status check.

Method / explanation: [Fact] PIB material recorded the Kulasekarapattinam SSLV launch complex as under construction on 21 June 2026. [Analysis] An approved or under-construction launch facility is not an operational facility.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q99. Answer: C | Current Affairs

A policy analyst uses India's BRICS 2026 chairship launch (13 January 2026) to make the following claims: 1. Chairship-process activity and a concluded summit outcome are distinct statuses. 2. A dated target, allocation, approval or meeting may be treated as an achieved outcome without checking status. 3. The competent institution and legal category must be identified before drawing an inference. Which claims are methodologically sound?

A. 1 and 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: claim 2 is precisely the status error that current-affairs elimination should reject.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: claim 1 is also sound, whereas claim 2 is not.

C. 1 and 3 only - CORRECT: Correct: claims 1 and 3 preserve conceptual and institutional discipline; claim 2 collapses announced or intermediate status into achievement.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be accepted because claim 2 removes the required status check.

Method / explanation: [Fact] India launched the BRICS 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026; this did not establish that a Leaders' Summit had already been completed. [Analysis] Chairship-process activity and a concluded summit outcome are distinct statuses.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q100. Answer: D | Current Affairs

A policy analyst uses BIMSTEC maritime transport agreement (16 May 2026) to make the following claims: 1. Entry into force among depositing states should not be described as binding every member automatically. 2. A dated target, allocation, approval or meeting may be treated as an achieved outcome without checking status. 3. The competent institution and legal category must be identified before drawing an inference. Which claims are methodologically sound?

A. 1 and 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: claim 2 is precisely the status error that current-affairs elimination should reject.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: claim 1 is also sound, whereas claim 2 is not.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be accepted because claim 2 removes the required status check.

D. 1 and 3 only - CORRECT: Correct: claims 1 and 3 preserve conceptual and institutional discipline; claim 2 collapses announced or intermediate status into achievement.

Method / explanation: [Fact] The BIMSTEC maritime transport agreement entered into force on 16 May 2026 among Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, the four states then recorded as having deposited instruments. [Analysis] Entry into force among depositing states should not be described as binding every member automatically.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

END OF DETAILED SOLUTIONS